

# Beyond SAP ECC 2027

A Practical S/4HANA Upgrade Guide  
for Enterprise Leaders

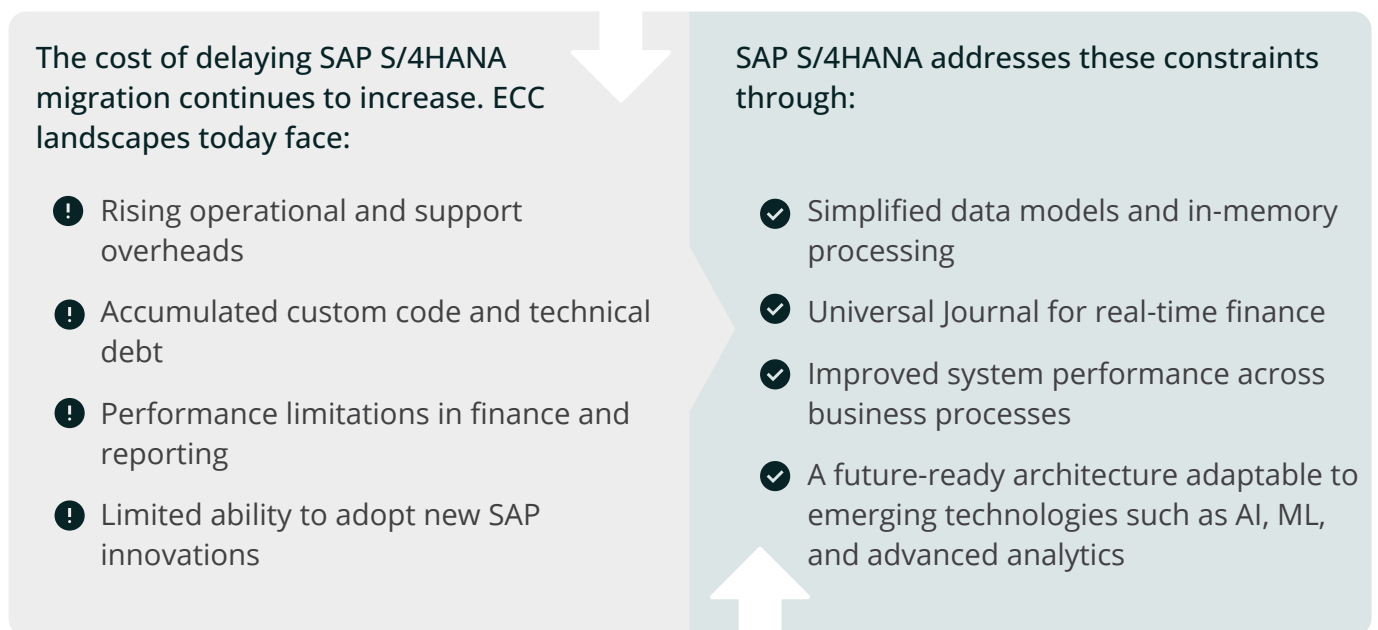


# A Practical Perspective for Enterprise Decision-Makers

SAP S/4HANA is not a routine system upgrade. It represents a mandatory shift to a real-time digital core driven by SAP's end of mainstream ECC support in 2027. Organisations running SAP ECC must now plan a controlled, risk-managed transition to ensure continuity of business processes, compliance, and long-term system viability.

RheinBrücke SAP practice focuses on how to move to SAP S/4HANA in a structured and predictable manner, minimising disruption while preserving existing investments and operational stability.

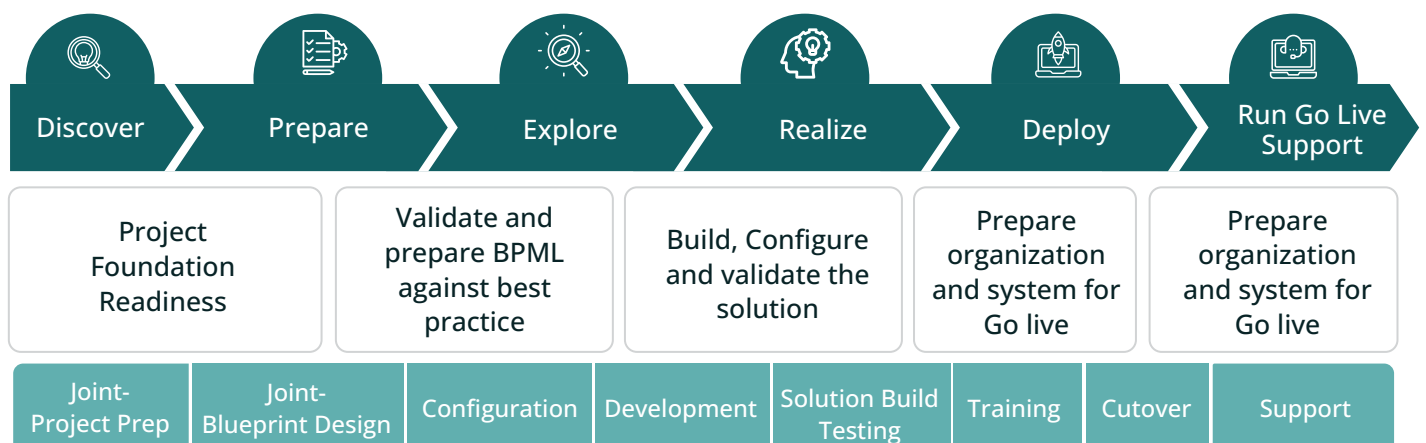
## Why Organisations Are Upgrading Now



A structured migration approach significantly reduces technical, and business risk compared to deferred or reactive upgrades.

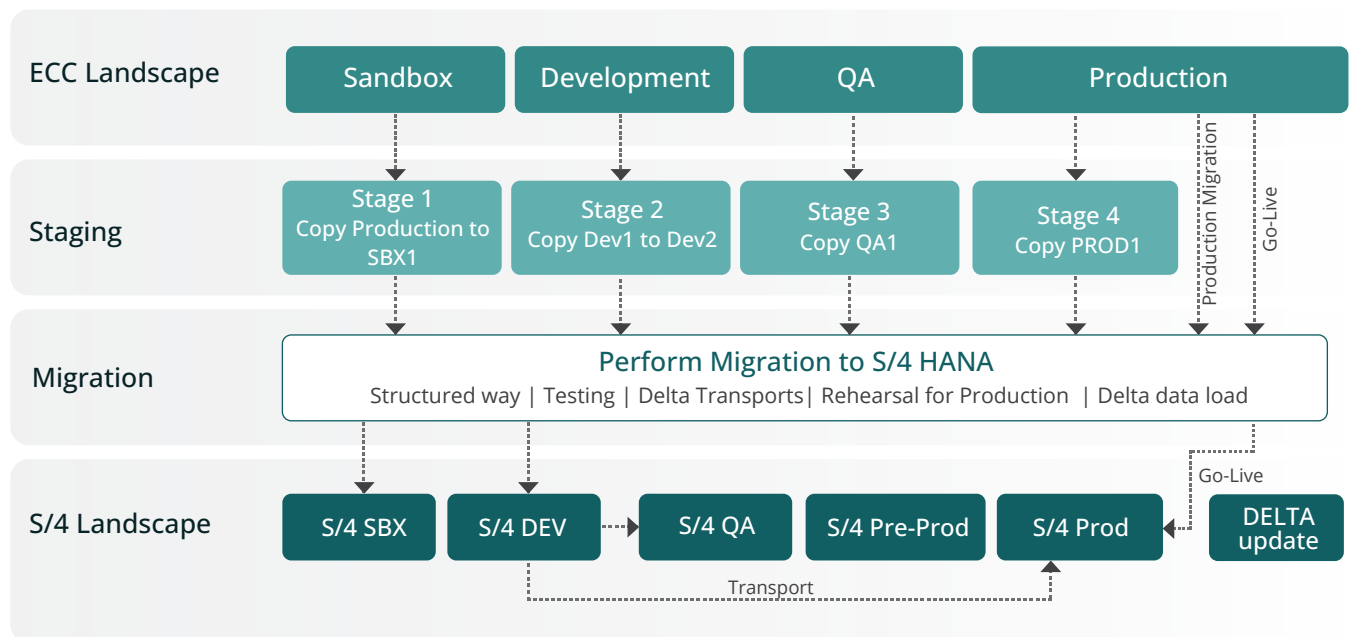
## Choosing the Right Upgrade Path

Selecting the appropriate migration approach is the most critical success factor in any S/4HANA program.



# System Conversion (Brownfield)

We deliver a comprehensive portfolio of digital solutions designed to unlock business potential:



- ➔ Converts existing ECC system to S/4HANA
- ➔ Retains historical data and core configurations
- ➔ Enables faster timeline, with reduced operational disruption



**Best suited for:** Organisations with stable processes and managed customisation



**Key risk:** Carrying forward unnecessary legacy complexity if not addressed in time

# New Implementation (Greenfield)

- ➔ Rebuilds processes using SAP Best Practices
- ➔ Maximum simplification and standardisation

A misaligned upgrade path is the most common cause of SAP S/4HANA program overruns and value leakage.



**Best suited for:** Highly customised or fragmented ECC landscapes



**Key risk:** Increased organisational change and data migration effort

# Landscape Transformation

- ➔ Consolidates or separates systems during upgrade
- ➔ Enables harmonisation across regions or business units



## Best suited for:

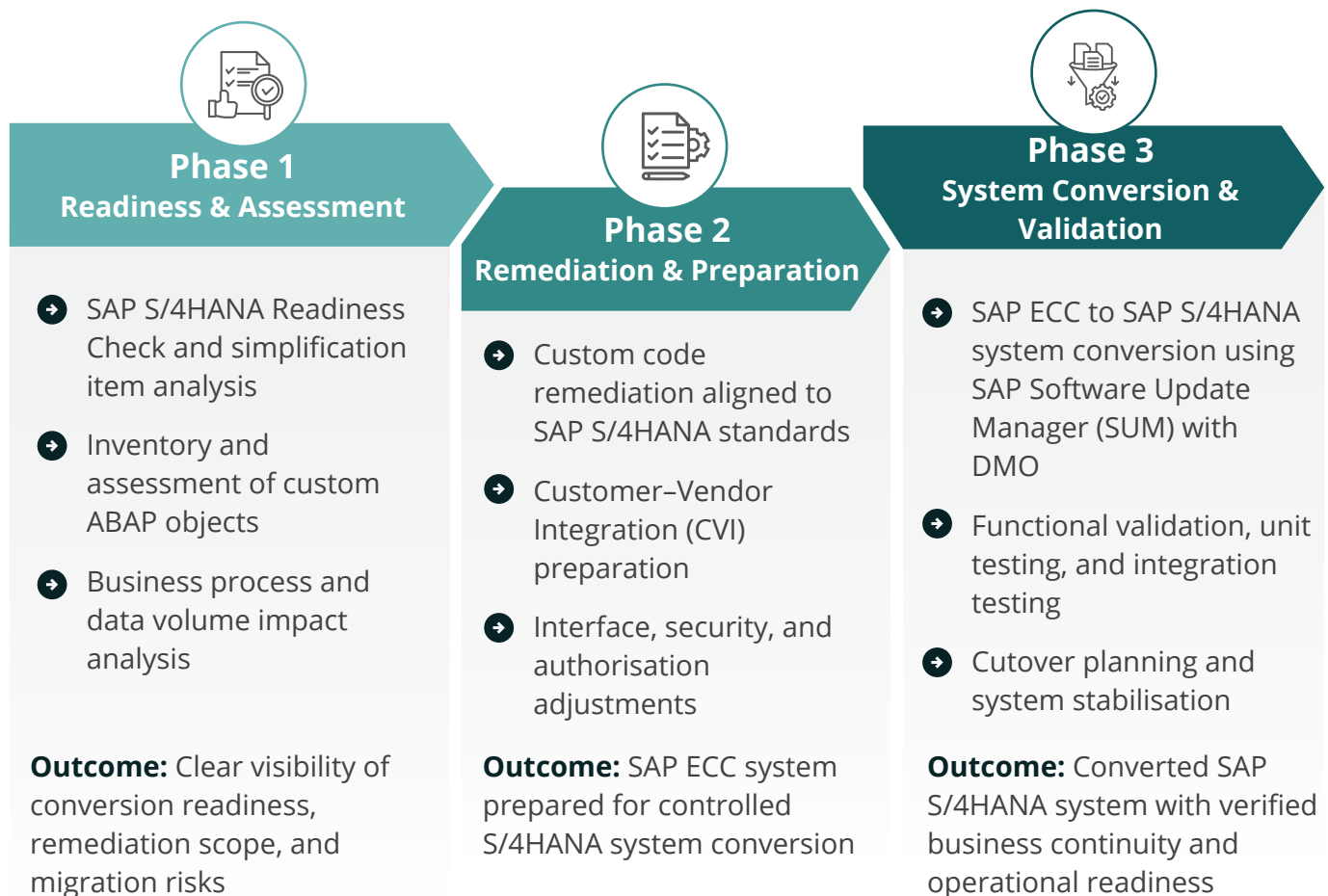
Multi-system or post-merger environments



**Key risk:** Higher planning, governance and execution complexity

## Structured Upgrade Approach

A phased, SAP-aligned migration model ensures predictability, control, and risk mitigation throughout the SAP S/4HANA conversion lifecycle.



## Industry-Specific Upgrade Considerations

Typical considerations observed during SAP S/4HANA system conversions include:



### Discrete & Automotive Manufacturing

- Improved MRP performance and production visibility
- Real-time cost and margin insight



### Process Manufacturing & Life Sciences

- Enhanced batch traceability and compliance reporting
- Integrated quality and costing data



### EPC / Engineering & Construction

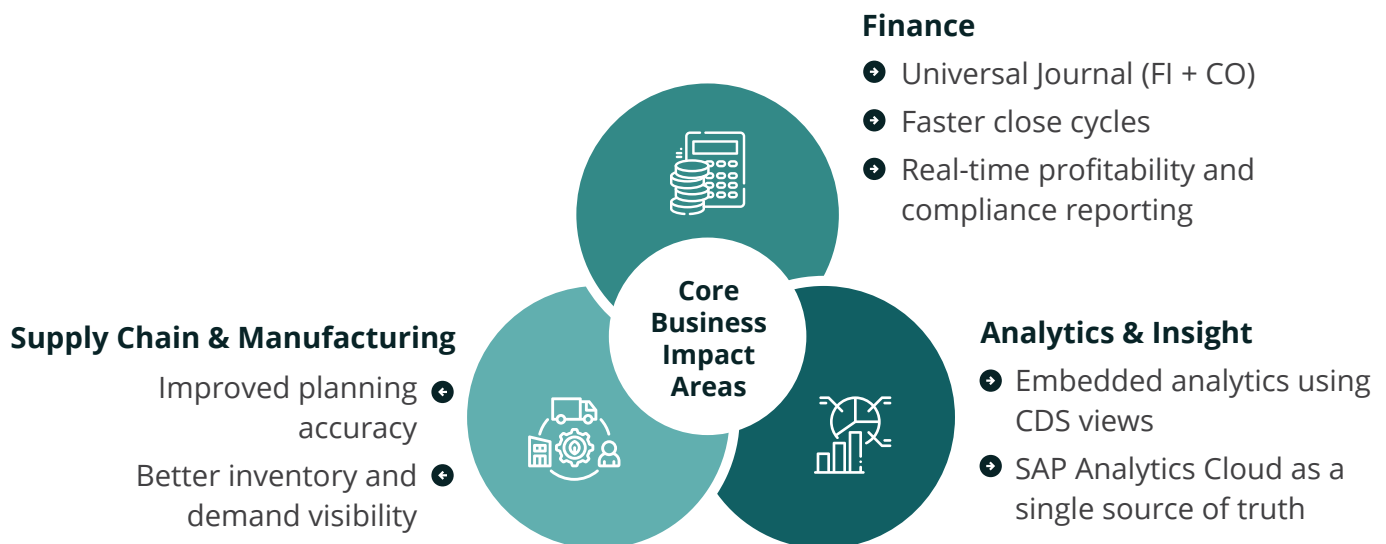
- Improved project cost and budget control
- Enhanced WBS-level visibility



### Asset-Intensive & Energy Businesses

- Integrated asset lifecycle, maintenance, and financial visibility

## Core Business Impact Areas



A successful SAP S/4HANA upgrade is defined by business outcomes, not go-live dates. Clarity on upgrade path, scope, and risk is what separates value creation from technical debt.

**Assess your SAP S/4HANA upgrade readiness ahead of the 2027 deadline.**  
**Talk to our experts today.**



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